First conducted in 1997, the India Today Best Colleges Survey in its first year ranked only engineering, medical and law colleges. The following year, Arts, Science and Commerce were added. Over the years, as the methodology was regularly revised and updated to make the evaluation more robust and objective, the rankings saw the addition of new streams such as Architecture, Dental Sciences, Mass Communication, Hotel Management, BBA, BCA, Social Work and Fashion Design. Now in its 28th year, a lookback at the top institutes across all streams. Competition may have been snapping at their heels, but these toppers have always been one step ahead

